

Exercise with diabetes

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Exercise for diabetes | Type 1 and type 2 | Diabetes UK

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Exercise for diabetes

Being physically active is good for people with diabetes — whatever type you have — and for people with prediabetes and others at risk of type 2 diabetes, like women who have or have had gestational diabetes. Regularly taking time to move more can benefit both your physical and mental health. Whether you feel able to go for a run or a swim or can manage some arm stretches or on-the-spot walking while the kettle boils, it all makes a difference. That's because being physically active helps insulin work better in your body – either the insulin you take or the insulin your body makes. This helps keep your blood sugar levels within target and helps prevent other health problems linked to diabetes, known as complications. Find out the other benefits of being more physically active and our advice on where to start. Think of it simply as 'activity'. On this page: [Benefits of exercise](#) [Best exercise for diabetes](#) [Setting targets](#) [Ideas for keeping active at home](#) [Ideas for keeping active when you're out](#) [Ideas for keeping active at work](#) [Exercise classes and online workouts](#) [Exercise and diabetes complications](#) [Tips to help with fear of hypos](#) {"preview_thumbnail":"/resources-s3/public/styles/video_embed_wysiwyg_preview/public/video_thumbnails/LZIVVic8DM.jpg?itok=l-sO6_Ms","video_url":"https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LZIVVic8DM","settings":{"responsive":1,"width":854,"height":480,"autoplay":0},"settings_summary":["Embedded Video (Responsive)."]}

[Benefits of exercise](#) There are many benefits of being active if you live with type 1 diabetes , type 2 diabetes , or have gestational diabetes (high blood sugar levels in pregnancy) or other types of diabetes or are at risk of type 2 diabetes. Moving more can: [Help your body use insulin better](#). If you take insulin, regular activity may reduce how much you need to take by reducing insulin resistance [Help you keep your blood sugar levels within target range](#) and [improve your HbA1c](#) [Help some people with type 2 diabetes put it into remission](#)

To help you get started we've created [Your guide to Moving More \(PDF, 2.9MB\)](#). There's space for you to plan your activity and track your progress, as well as lots of information to support you along the way. Don't be hard on yourself if there are days you feel tired and unmotivated. You could try resting in the morning and then introducing some movement into your afternoon. However, sometimes you need a break or time to relax, and it's okay to do that. And remember to celebrate your milestones with treats that mean something to you – this could be a day out somewhere with family or friends. [Breaking up periods of inactivity](#) [Breaking up long periods of sitting or lying down](#) regularly can help lower your blood sugar levels. So, for example, you might stand up for a while every 30 to 45 minutes or make phone calls standing up. Standing uses up more than twice as much energy (calories) as sitting, as well as being better for your body. [Ideas for keeping active at home](#) You can also reap the benefits of being active without having to brave the outside. “We know that home can be a great place for people to start moving more, without the need for expensive gym memberships or sports equipment,” says Diabetes UK's Senior Physical Activity Advisor Neil Gibson. This is particularly beneficial during the winter months when it's cold outside and it gets dark earlier. [On-the-spot walking](#) during TV ad breaks or when you're waiting for the kettle to boil. [Stretches for your arms and legs](#) whilst sitting in a chair. [Vacuuming your home](#) or [washing your car](#). [Gardening](#) - if you have a garden. If you don't, do you have any house plants you can water, prune and re-pot while standing up. Put some music on and have a dance. Stand up for work meetings or phone calls and consider a standing desk. Housework can be a great way to let off steam, raise the pulse and work a

range of muscle groups. Strength training can be done while standing, sitting or lying down. Use tins, bottles or water jugs f

Try one of our free video workouts with Celene and other fitness instructors suitable for people with diabetes — from 4 minutes to 30 minutes, on our YouTube channel. Staying connected with others can also help with both your physical and mental health. So, think about getting moving with family, friends or neighbours. Or even doing one of our fundraising events that helps you get active and raise money, so we can keep working towards a world where diabetes can do no harm. Are there any unsuitable exercises for diabetes? If you have prediabetes, type 1 diabetes, type 2 diabetes or other types of diabetes, you're able to take part in almost every type of physical activity. You may need to meet certain criteria and have a medical assessment for extreme activities such as scuba diving, skydiving and mountaineering. For diving guidance, see more information on the diabetes page of the UK Diving Medical Committee website . Speak to your healthcare team It's good to be active, but you also need to take care of your body. Before trying any new exercises, it's important you check with your GP first. They can help you decide what's safe and consider any complications you have. Exercise and diabetes complications You can still exercise if you have diabetes complications such as problems with your eyes or heart, but you'll need to think a bit more about the activity you choose. And talk it through with your healthcare team. For example, you should avoid high-intensity activity such as high-intensity interval training (HIIT) and heavy lifting. But there are other gentler, low impact exercises you can try, such as swimming, cycling or walking. Nerve disease Do mostly activities where you aren't putting weight on your feet, for example, swimming or chair-based exercises, especially if your gait – the way that you walk – has changed or if you have a foot deformity. If you have regular appointments with a foot care specialist or team, always talk to them about whether an activity i

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